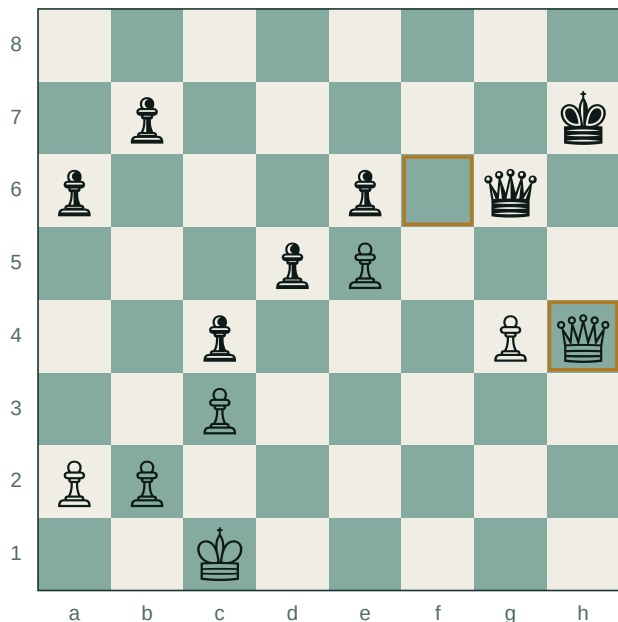


Queen-ending tactics: Black, move 33

Queen-ending tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 33.Qh4+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

33...Qh6+ 34. Qxh6+ Kxh6

33...Qh6+ Check restricts White to 6 legal replies here. From h6 it attacks king on c1 and queen on h4. Recorded reply: **34.Qxh6+**.

34...Kxh6 The king captures the queen on h6.

At the end, nominal material is White 5 / Black 5 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from +0 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A favorable-looking queen exchange can lead to a drawn pawn ending. Evaluate the new ending before simplifying.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Queens combine long-range checks with promotion support. King shelter and the order of checks often matter more than a small material lead.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect perpetual-check possibilities, queen trades, and checks that gain a tempo for a passed pawn.

The defending king is on c1. Geometrically undefended: queen on h4. Check for tactical protection.